

JONATHAN SANTUCCI (#22), NEW YORK METS

Level: AA (Binghamton Rumble Ponies)

Position(s): LHP

Age: 23

B/T: L/L

Dates Seen: 6/12/26

Projected Role: Back-end Starter

Ceiling: Mid-rotation Starter

Floor: Multi-inning Reliever/Low-leverage
Relief Arm

Report: 2026 Preseason

Org Rk	Ovr Rk	ETA	FV
8	N/A	2027	45+

Fastball	Slider	Changeup
55 / 55	55 / 60	40 / 50

Command
30 / 40

Delivery

Santucci started for the Rumble Ponies and displayed an aggressive, downhill motion with a high $\frac{3}{4}$ arm slot. He starts from a hybrid windup and flashes the ball behind his leg for a brief moment while keeping his glove high, before finishing cleanly over his front leg and falling slightly off towards the 3rd base line. Santucci, 6/2, 205 pounds, is a lean, lanky projectable starter with room to fill out.

Arsenal

Santucci showed his deceptive slider throughout his outing, often throwing it to the back foot of righties and getting many whiffs. During his more efficient at-bats, he would throw his slider early for a strike to set up his fastball up in the zone, then finish the batter off with his slider, often getting the batter to expand the zone and chase. During inefficient at-bats, his fastball consistently missed down, putting him behind in the count. He relied on his slider to get whiffs and strikeouts with runners on when he could not find the feel of his fastball.

Overall, the slider is a very effective pitch that can get whiffs, especially to righties, and often leaves lefties looking. The attack angle of his slider aligns with the attack angle of his fastball, making the tunnel off one another extremely dependable when on. If he can get ahead in counts to get into better situations to throw his slider, he can be an effective LHP. Especially if he can work the slider early the first time through the batting order, he would be able to pitch backward to hitters the second time through, which would play up his 87-93 fastball. When Santucci has a good feel for his pitches, he can rack up the strikeouts. In 2025 and 2026, Santucci's K/9 has remained above 10.50.

Command

Santucci struggled with command to the tune of 5 BBs over 4 IP on 6/12. His overall feel of pitches definitely improved over the game, but he still had a < 50% strike rate in the bottom of the 4th. In Santucci's next start after his wild outing in Somerset, he vastly improved his command to deliver a dominant outing against the New Hampshire Rivercats. He threw 7 shutout innings, walking only 2 while striking out 7. In his start against Somerset, he threw 49% of his pitches for strikes, compared to 64% in his start against the Rivercats. He did not throw a first-pitch ball until 2 outs in the 4th, showing that the command that evaded him against Somerset did not carry over.

The following start on 6/24 showed the inconsistency of Santucci's command. Santucci threw 3.1 innings, allowing 4 runs (3 earned) on 4 hits and 3 walks, while striking out 5. Santucci's overall strike percentage dipped back down below 60% in this start, throwing 47 of 84 pitches for strikes, a 56% clip. Santucci has shown inconsistency with command throughout these three starts, which is a troubling sign given his overall walk trend this year.

Development Path

Santucci needs to throw more strikes to get to his highly effective slider. Santucci has previously offset his walk rate with a high strikeout rate in his minor league career. In 2025, he posted a K/9 of 10.56, a BB/9 of 3.14, and a WHIP of 1.02. This led him to throw an average of 15.62 pitches per inning (P/IP) or 3.82 pitches per plate appearance, and to post a 2.98 xFIP overall in 2025. In 2026, his K/9 has slightly increased to 10.80. However, his BB/9 and WHIP have increased at a much larger rate, rising from 3.14 to 4.61 and from 1.02 to 1.33. At the same time, his P/IP has increased by 1.64 pitches per inning and his additional pitches per plate appearance by .286. He is walking more hitters, throwing more pitches to each hitter, and working longer innings this year, which has led to an increased xFIP of 4.03, 1.05 higher than last year. Santucci shows the high ceiling he has as an LHP with a strong fastball-slider combination, but also the warning signs that arise when he lacks command of his fastball. Even if he reduces his pitch usage to just fastball and slider, he could be a good relief arm out of the bullpen if he continues with control issues that limit him as a starter. That said, he remains a projectable arm with a strong track record in 2025, and he should have continued chances to prove himself as a starter.